Country Summary: Spain



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Executive summary of the Spain country profile (2026-10-30). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in Spain_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.

At a Glance

49.8 m Population, 1 July 2026, provisional[3]	**59,870** GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025[5]	**9.22%** Current health expenditure, share of GDP, 2023[25]	**20.9%** Out-of-pocket share of current health expenditure, 2023[27]
4.4 Physicians per 1,000 people, 2023[12]	**83.9** Life expectancy at birth, years, 2024[11]	**21.6%** Population aged 65 and over, 2025[9]	**US$3,107** Current health expenditure per capita, 2023, current US$[26]

Country background

Spain, a parliamentary monarchy with its capital in Madrid, had about 49.8 million residents on 1 July 2026 (provisional).[2,3] King Felipe VI is head of state, and Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez has led a minority government.[2,13] Mónica García is Minister of Health.[7] The economy grew 2.6 percent year on year in the second quarter of 2026, and GDP per person was about 59,870 international dollars (PPP) in 2025.[5,17] The population is aging: 21.6 percent were 65 or older in 2025, and life expectancy was 83.9 years in 2024.[9,11] The key risk is political: a snap general election is set for 29 November 2026, and policy is on hold until a new government forms.[14,38]

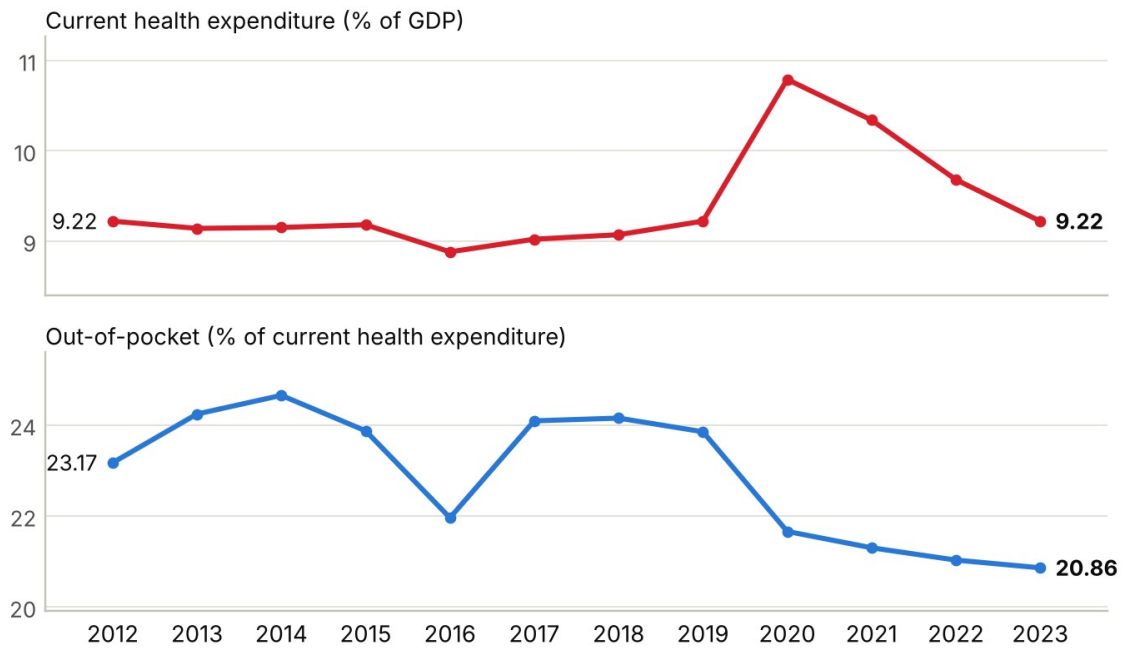
Key takeaways for CSI

- Health spending was 9.22 percent of GDP in 2023, unchanged from 2012, and 20.9 percent was out of pocket.[25,27]
- At 31 December 2025, 853,740 patients were waiting for elective surgery, with an average wait of 122 days.[20]
- Spain had 4.4 physicians per 1,000 people in 2023, but 43 percent were aged 55 and over in 2022.[12]
- The share aged 65 and over is projected to rise from 20 percent in 2024 to 33 percent by 2050.[12]

Health System

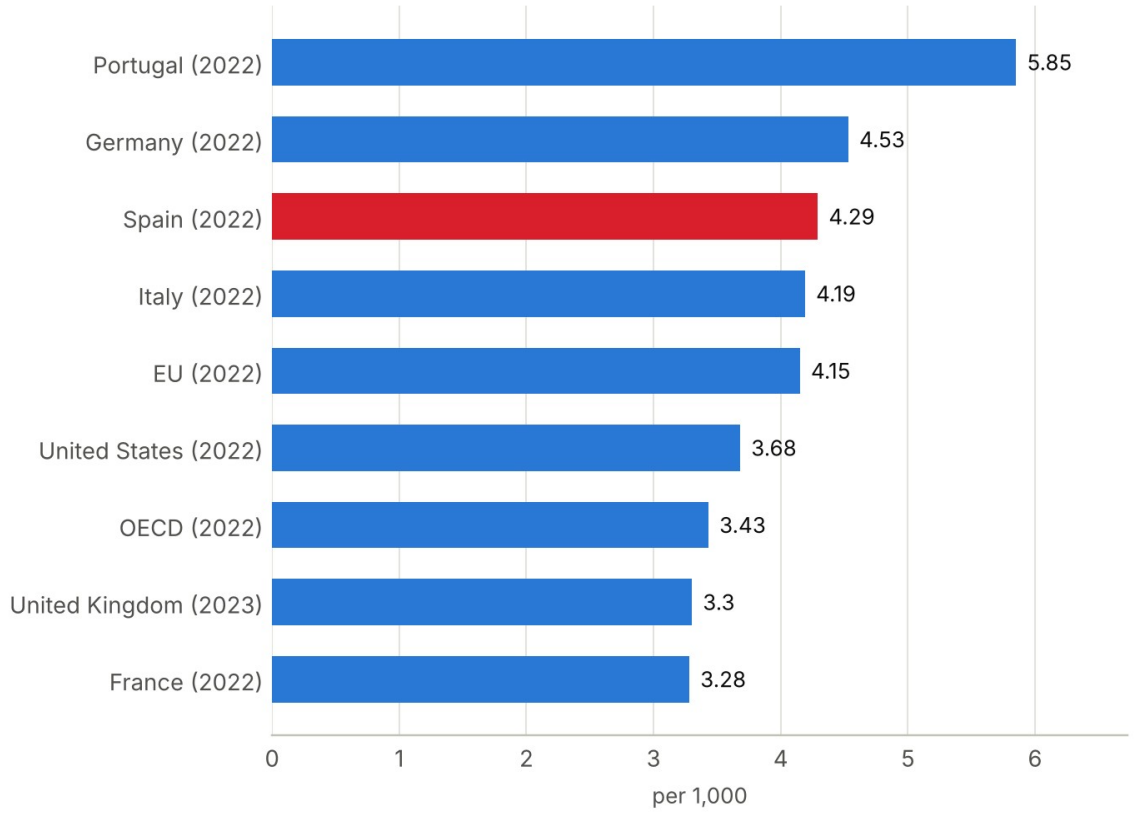
- The tax-funded National Health System covers all residents, and regions made up 93.6 percent of public health spending in 2024.[12,16]
- Unmet needs for medical care were 2.6 percent in 2024, below the EU average of 3.6 percent.[12]
- The average wait for a first hospital specialist consultation was 102 days at 31 December 2025.[20]

Spain: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2023



Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure; 2023 is the latest year in the series. Sources: [25,27]

Physicians per 1,000 people, Spain and comparators (latest year available)

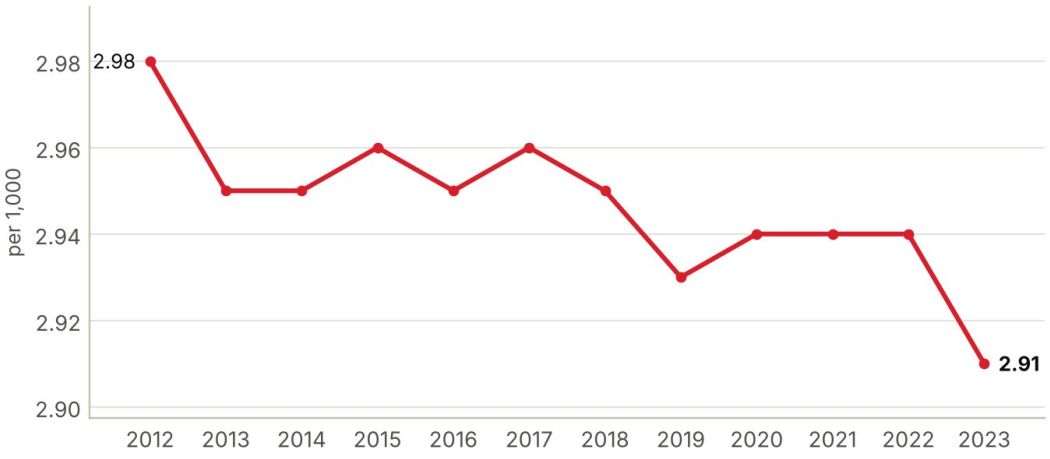


Latest year available for each country in the World Bank series, shown in brackets; comparison years differ (2022 and 2023). Portugal's figure counts all doctors licensed to practise, which overstates practising doctors. Sources: [12,34]

Market and Competition

- In 2025, 440 hospitals were private (57 percent of the total), and health insurers covered 12.8 million people.[21]
- Foreign groups are well established: Fresenius owns Quirónsalud, Bupa owns Sanitas, and Hospiten runs MD Anderson Cancer Center Madrid.[23,24,41]
- The tracker lists 20 active foreign partnerships in Spain, in Barcelona (ten), Madrid (nine) and Valencia (one).

Spain: hospital beds per 1,000 people, 2012 to 2023



Hospital beds as reported to the World Bank, public and private; 2023 is the latest year in the series. Sources: [33]

Foreign health systems active in Spain

20 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (20 in all): 6 training and education, 6 ownership or management, 5 research collaboration, 3 clinical affiliation. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.



Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in Spain. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-30. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Cleveland Clinic	Training and education
George Washington University (School of Medicine and Health Sciences)	Training and education
Harvard Medical School (Harvard University)	Training and education
Johns Hopkins University (Bloomberg School of Public Health)	Research collaboration
MD Anderson Cancer Center	Clinical affiliation

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Mount Sinai Health System (Icahn School of Medicine, Mount Sinai Fuster Heart Hospital)	Research collaboration
Penn State College of Medicine and Penn State Health (Beat Childhood Cancer Research Consortium)	Research collaboration
University of Illinois Chicago (College of Applied Health Sciences)	Training and education
University of Kansas Medical Center	Training and education
ABC Medical Center (Centro Médico ABC)	Training and education
Aier Eye Hospital Group	Ownership or management
Bupa	Ownership or management
Burjeel Cancer Institute (Burjeel Holdings)	Clinical affiliation
Cancer Core Europe (Gustave Roussy, DKFZ and NCT Heidelberg, Netherlands Cancer Institute, Karolinska Institutet, Cancer Research UK Cambridge Centre, Istituto Nazionale dei Tumori Milan)	Research collaboration
Clariane (formerly Korian)	Ownership or management
Fresenius Helios (Helios Health)	Ownership or management
GenesisCare	Ownership or management
Grupo Médico Joya (Hospitales Joya)	Clinical affiliation
Sun Yat-sen University Cancer Center	Research collaboration
Vivalto Santé	Ownership or management

CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

CSI partnerships in Spain

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Opportunities for CSI

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To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Risks and watch items

- A snap general election is set for 29 November 2026, and policy is on hold until a new government forms.[14,38]
- The 2023 state budget has been rolled over into 2026, a third year.[15]
- The end of NextGenerationEU funding could weigh on investment.[18]

Recent developments

2026-10-07 Doctors' unions postponed the indefinite strike planned from 28 October, saying the Estatuto Marco bill lapses.[38]

2026-07-21 The government sent the Cortes a Medicines and Health Products bill and a tobacco bill.[39]

2026-05-13 The Ministry of Health reported public health spending of €101.7 billion (US$114 billion) in 2024, 6.4 percent of GDP.[16]